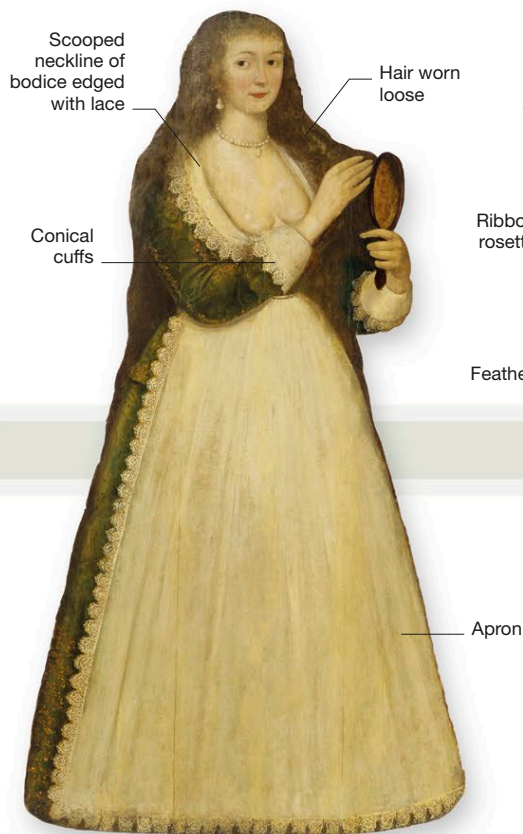
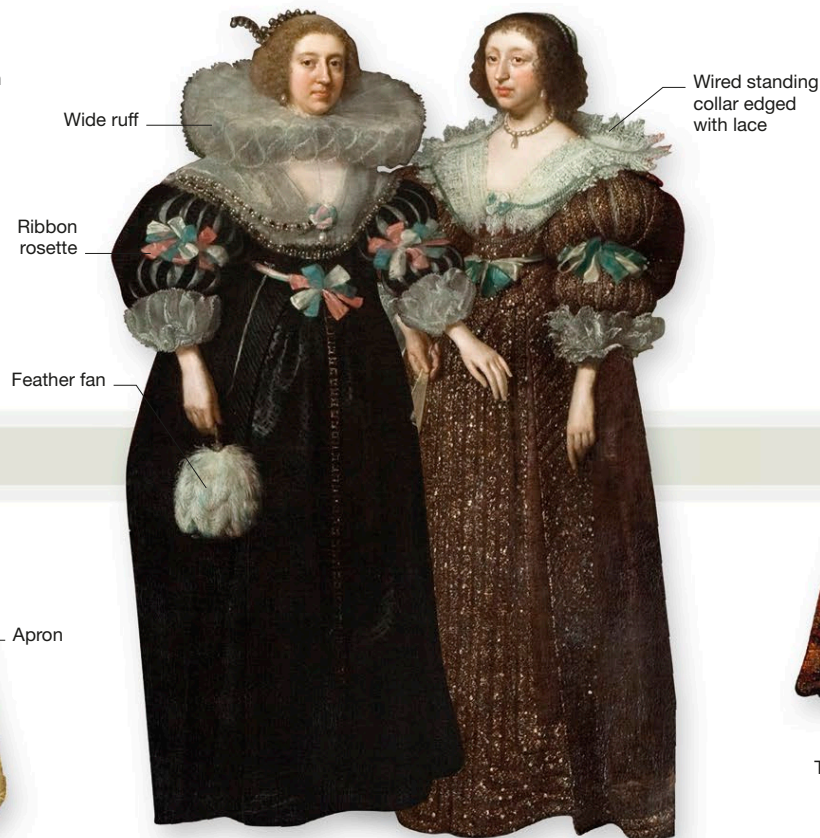




Low décolletage Queen Anne, wife of King James I of England, was sometimes portrayed wearing low-necked dresses. For modesty, a revealing neckline could be covered by a linen garment called a partlet, which was stitched to the shift.



Full sleeves A much fuller, elbow-length style was the fashion for sleeves in the later 1620s. They were often paned – made of worked and finished strips of silk fabric – with the puffs separated by ribbon ties and rosettes.



Voluminous silhouette The fullness of the skirt and the puffed sleeves, plus the trailing hems, gave a round shape to women's dress in the 1630s. In the Dutch United Provinces dark colours were popular, worn here with a large pleated ruff.



Sombrero The Spanish artist Zurbaran painted this portrait of the 4th-century, and possibly fictitious, Saint Margaret of Antioch. She wears the Iberian sombrero, which inspired the fashion for soft plumed hats in the rest of Europe.



Lustrous silk In the 1630s dresses were made of light-coloured silk satins that shimmered in the candlelight. The high-waisted styles often had a low-cut bodice edged with costly lace, which matched the lace on the separate cuffs.

JEWELLERY



On formal occasions jewellery – along with lace and rich materials – was one of the most important components of women's fashionable dress. Seventeenth-century paintings and prints show that the “must have” piece of jewellery of the 1630s was a breast ornament, rather like a brooch, worn at the centre front of the bodice. Portrait painters showed women wearing two or three necklaces of gemstones; and strings of pearls too were a popular choice. Pearls were also worn as drop earrings and as hair ornaments.